

MARCH 30

The NVA launches the Easter Offensive, a large-scale invasion of South Vietnam, using armored vehicles and artillery to strike across the DMZ toward the city of Quang Tri.



NVA volunteer corps soldier with an anti-aircraft gun, 1972

APRIL 4

In response to the Easter Offensive, President Nixon authorizes the bombing of North Vietnam up to the 18th parallel.

APRIL 7

After a three-day battle, North Vietnamese and Viet Cong forces capture the town of Loc Ninh, near the Cambodian border north of Saigon.

APRIL 10

B-52 bombers begin large-scale raids on targets deep inside North Vietnam as America escalates the air war.

APRIL 12

Communist forces advance from base areas in Laos and Cambodia toward Kontum.

APRIL 13

The city of An Loc, north of Saigon, comes under attack and its defenders are placed under siege by communist forces.

APRIL 27

F-4 Phantoms armed with laser-guided bombs strike the Thanh Hoa bridge, a vital communications link in North Vietnam.